

COLLECTION · SELLERS

Selling at the Best Price

The 7-step game plan — from pricing to closing

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Selling at the Best Price

The 7-step game plan — from pricing to closing

Selling your property at the best price is no fluke: it's the result of a method. A good starting price, preparation, marketing, negotiation and follow-through to signing — every step counts.

This guide presents the 7-step game plan a broker uses to maximize the price and minimize stress. You'll know what to do, in what order, and why.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page to prepare YOUR sale.

Selling at the best price isn't hoping for a miracle: it's stringing together seven controlled steps, from the right starting price to signing. This guide walks through them, with the mistakes to avoid at each phase.

The through-line: price and preparation weigh far more than luck. What you control at the start determines the final result.

CHAPTER

Steps 1-2: the right price and preparation

Starting on the right footing: a fair price and a ready property.

Step 1 — Set the right price

The starting price is the most strategic decision. Too high, the property stalls, wears out on the market and ultimately sells for less; too low, you leave money on the table. The price is set from a comparative market analysis (recent similar sales), not from a wish.

Step 2 — Prepare the property

- Declutter, deep-clean, depersonalize.
- Minor repairs that jump out (handles, seals, touch-ups).
- Light home staging to showcase the spaces (see the dedicated guide).

The starting price is the most consequential decision: too high, the property stalls and gets “burned”; just right, it attracts quickly and can create competition. Preparation (cleaning, decluttering, small repairs) then multiplies the effect of a good price.

EMILIE'S TIP

An overpriced property at the start almost always sells for less in the end: it becomes “the one that lingers”. The right price from day 1 creates the buzz that drives offers up.

CHAPTER

Steps 3-4: marketing and showings

Exposing the property to the most qualified buyers.

Step 3 — Go to market

- Professional photos, video, a polished description (see the marketing guide).
- Wide distribution (Centris, networks, the broker network).
- A complete, honest listing to attract the right buyers.

Step 4 — Manage the showings

Make visits easy (availability, constant cleanliness, owners absent). Every visit is an opportunity: a house that's hard to visit is a house that sells for less.

Marketing aims to expose the property to the most qualified buyers: professional photos, a polished description, wide distribution, well-organized visits. The first weeks concentrate most of the interest — be impeccable from the very first day online.

EMILIE'S TIP

The first weeks are the most important: that's when interest is highest. A well-prepared, well-priced property often creates its best offers early.

CHAPTER

Steps 5-6: offers and negotiation

Turning interest into the best accepted offer.

An offer is assessed as a whole: price, conditions, dates, the strength of the buyer's financing. The highest isn't always the best if its conditions are fragile.

- Analyze each offer: price, conditions (inspection, financing), deadlines.
- Negotiate or make a counter-offer while keeping your goal in mind.
- In multiple offers, a governed strategy maximizes the result (see the dedicated guide).

An offer is assessed as a whole: price, but also conditions, possession dates and the strength of the financing. The best offer isn't always the highest if it's fragile. Respond on the facts, keep your strategy, and let your broker lead the negotiation.

EMILIE'S TIP

Don't be dazzled by the number alone. A slightly lower offer that's condition-free and well-financed is sometimes safer — and more rewarding — than a high, fragile one.

CHAPTER

Step 7: from acceptance to closing

Securing the sale through to signing.

An accepted offer isn't a closed sale: the conditions remain to be fulfilled (inspection, the buyer's financing, document review). Good follow-through keeps the transaction from derailing in this sensitive period.

- Make the inspection and access to the requested documents easy.
- Provide the notary with the required documents (location certificate, seller's declaration).
- Prepare your own move and the handover of the keys.

An accepted offer isn't a closed sale: the conditions remain to be fulfilled (inspection, financing) and the road to the notary remains. Stay available, provide the documents quickly and anticipate the buyer's requests so a condition doesn't derail the sale.

EMILIE'S TIP

Stay collaborative during the fulfillment of conditions: a transaction well supported through to the notary is one that reaches the finish. That's where a broker's experience makes the difference.

CHAPTER

The selling mistakes to avoid

Not sabotaging your own sale.

Some very common mistakes cost the seller dearly:

- **Overpricing** the starting price: the property stalls and gets “burned”.
- Neglecting the **preparation** and the photos.
- Making the **visits** hard to arrange.
- Reacting to **emotion** rather than the facts in negotiation.

The good news: these mistakes are all avoidable with a little method and perspective.

The classic mistakes cost dearly: overpricing, neglecting preparation and photos, making visits difficult, or negotiating on emotion. All are avoidable with method. A well-priced, well-presented property often sells faster AND for more than an overpriced one that lingers.

EMILIE'S TIP

The first weeks on the market are the most precious: that's when interest is highest. Too high a price at the start wastes that momentum, and a property that lingers often ends up selling for less.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Have a comparative analysis prepared to set the right price.
2. Start the decluttering and small repairs.

Within 30 days

1. Carry out professional photos and marketing.
2. Arrange flexible, well-prepared visits.

Next

1. Analyze the offers with Emilie and secure the transaction through to the notary.

Before going to market

1. Have a comparative analysis established and set a fair price.
2. Prepare the property (declutter, repair, clean) and plan professional photos.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Comparative market analysis: recent similar sales used to set the price.
 - Home staging: showcasing the property for the sale.
 - Marketing: photos, distribution and description to attract buyers.
 - Fulfillment of conditions: the period when the buyer validates inspection and financing.
 - Closing: signing the deed of sale at the notary.
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- Starting price: a key decision; too high, it scares off and “burns” the property.
 - Comparative analysis: recent similar sales used to set the price.
 - Days on market: the time listed; it lengthens when the price is too high.
 - Fulfillment of conditions: the step where the buyer confirms inspection and financing.
 - Home staging: preparing the property to maximize its appeal.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. The most strategic decision of the sale is:

- A) The colour of the sign
- B) The starting price
- C) The moving date
- D) The notary's name

2. An overpriced property at the start:

- A) Sells for more
- B) Often sells for less in the end
- C) Sells faster
- D) Has no impact

3. The price is set from:

- A) A wish
- B) A comparative market analysis
- C) The original purchase price
- D) The neighbours' opinion

4. The most important weeks are:

- A) The last ones
- B) The first ones, when interest is highest
- C) None
- D) The winter ones

5. An offer is assessed:

- A) On price alone
- B) As a whole (price, conditions, dates, financing)
- C) At random
- D) On the signature only

6. An accepted offer is:

- A) A closed sale
- B) Still subject to the fulfillment of conditions
- C) Worthless
- D) Immediately final

7. During the fulfillment of conditions, you must:

- A) Ignore the buyer
- B) Stay collaborative and make access easy
- C) Refuse the inspection
- D) Change the price

8. Making visits easy allows you to:

- A) Sell for less
- B) Expose the property to more buyers
- C) Nothing
- D) Avoid offers

Answer key

- 1. **B** — The right price creates the buzz (ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — It becomes “the one that lingers” (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — Comparables give the value (ch. 1).
- 4. **B** — Interest peaks at launch (ch. 2).
- 5. **B** — The highest isn't always the best (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — Inspection, financing, documents remain to be fulfilled (ch. 4).
- 7. **B** — Good follow-through avoids derailment (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — A house that's easy to visit sells better (ch. 2).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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